25901900 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Special Examinations, July 2026 (for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025)

Third SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCENG200 - AN
INTRODUCTION TO PHONETICS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. The Centum-Satem division is based on [K] / [CO1]

   a). Grammar rules in PIE b). Sound changes in the PIE /k/ sound

   c). Word order patterns in PIE d). None of these

2. Identify the vowel sound of these words: east, people [U] / [CO2]

   a). /i:/ b). /æ/ c). /i/ d). /e/

3. Which sounds cannot appear in codas in standard English? [U] / [CO3]

   a). /t/, /d/ b). /h/, /j/, /w/ c). /m/, /n/ d). /s/, /z/

4. The Roman alphabet was adopted from [U] / [CO4]

   a). Greek b). Arabic

   c). Devanagari d). Chinese

5. Who developed the Cardinal Vowel System? [U] / [CO1]

a). Daniel Jones b). Bharata c). Alexander Melville Bell d). Panini

6. What type of diphthong is /əʊ/? [U] / [CO2]

a). Rising b). Centring

c). Closing d). Glottal

7. In non-rhotic accents, the word "car" in isolation is pronounced as: [U] / [CO3]

a). /kɑːr/ b). /kɑː/ c). /kar/ d). /kær/

8. /kʌp ə tiː/ (Cup of tea) involves [U] / [CO4]

a). Omission of /p/ b). Omission of /v/

c). Liaison d). Vowel substitution

9. Which word contains the /j/ sound at the beginning? [U] / [CO2]

a). Player b). jar

c). Yes d). Sorrow

10. Which approximant is a rhotic? [K] / [CO3]

a). /j/ b). /w/ c). /r/ d). /l/

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

11. What is linguistics? List its main branches and give a brief explanation of each. [U] / [CO1]

12. Write the phonemic transcriptions (in RP) for the following words using IPA symbols: stay, stone, king, fetch, arm, job, tool, cage, move, sweet. [A] / [CO2]

13. What are minimal pairs? Give two examples and explain their role in identifying phonemes. [U] / [CO3]

14. Differentiate between segmental and suprasegmental features of speech. [U] / [CO4]

15. Write a note on Modern English vocabulary. [U] / [CO1]

16. Describe the use and structure of the vowel diagram in phonetic study. [U] / [CO2]

17. Describe the general features of approximants and list the four approximants in English. [U] / [CO3]

18. Define sense groups and explain their role in communication. [U] / [CO4]

19. Analyse the sentence to explain stress placement: ‘She arrived at the hotel.’ [U] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

20. Describe the functions of the respiratory, phonatory and articulatory systems in speech production, highlighting the role of different organs in each. [U] / [CO1]

21. Define the Cardinal Vowel System and explain how the primary cardinal vowels differ from their secondary counterparts. [U] / [CO2]

22. Describe consonant clusters in English, outlining onset, coda, and medial clusters, and contrast them with abutting consonants using examples. [K] / [CO3]

23. Transcribe the following passage marking stress and intonation. [A] / [CO4]

Salesman: Good morning, sir! May I help you?
Customer: Yes, I’m looking for a birthday present for my daughter.
Salesman: We have jeans, tops, shorts and Bermudas.
Customer: I doubt my choice would match her taste. That watch looks interesting.
Salesman: That’s a Rado, sir, a reputed American brand.
Customer: It does look elegant. But what about Omega or Cartier?
Salesman: They’re available too, though quite expensive. May I ask your budget?
Customer: I was thinking of something like Seiko or Casio.
Salesman: I understand. To be honest, this isn’t a specialist watch shop. We only keep a few select pieces. If you like, here’s a wall clock with a cuckoo bird that calls out every hour. Children usually love it. Do you have grandchildren?
Customer: Yes, I do. They might enjoy that. But is there anything else?
Salesman: Certainly. Here’s a Chinese Ming vase—an imitation, but beautifully crafted and very striking.
Customer: You’re right, it looks quite attractive.
Salesman: Thank you. If you’re interested, we also have paintings.
Customer: I think I’ve decided. The vase is perfect, and the price is fair. Could you pack it for me?
Salesman: Of course, sir. Thank you very much.

[15x2 = 30]